

16

Ruy Lopez Tactical Grammar

The e5 pawn, back-rank pins, bishop sacrifices, and queenside traps hidden inside strategic play.



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

You will recognize the tactical mechanisms that make apparently quiet Spanish moves precise.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate candidates for the side to move, identify the opponent's strongest resource, and choose the resulting structure you can explain. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 091 | PAGE 4

Decode: The e5 pawn and the c6 pin*In Spanish tactics, ask whether the c6 knight is a defender in fact or only on paper.*

LESSON 092 | PAGE 8

Play: The e5 pawn and the c6 pin*In Spanish tactics, ask whether the c6 knight is a defender in fact or only on paper.*

LESSON 093 | PAGE 12

Decode: The bishop sacrifice on f7 or h7*A Greek-gift pattern needs access, support, and a trapped king.*

LESSON 094 | PAGE 16

Play: The bishop sacrifice on f7 or h7*A Greek-gift pattern needs access, support, and a trapped king.*

LESSON 095 | PAGE 20

Decode: Noah's Ark queenside trap*A trapping net is real only when every flight square is controlled.*

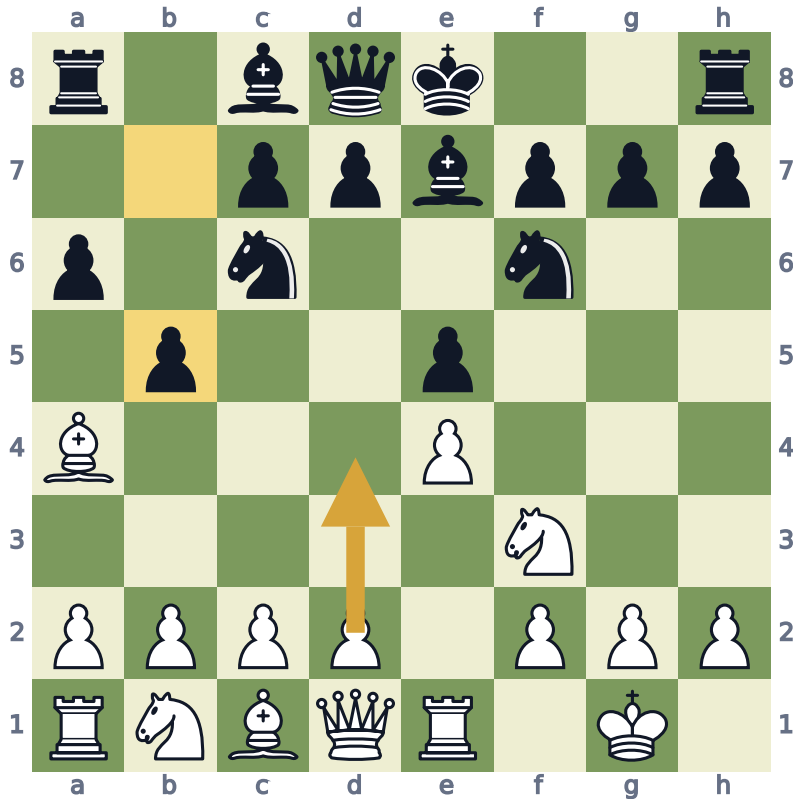
LESSON 096 | PAGE 24

Play: Noah's Ark queenside trap*A trapping net is real only when every flight square is controlled.***VOLUME OBJECTIVE**

You will recognize the tactical mechanisms that make apparently quiet Spanish moves precise.

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The e5 pawn and the c6 pin



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Pressure on e5 often depends on whether the c6 knight is pinned and whether Black has a tactical reply against e4.

DECISION RULE

If the c6 knight moves or disappears, what becomes loose on e5, d4, or b5?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

Unpin when necessary, defend e5 with active pieces, and use counter-pressure instead of piling up passive defenders.

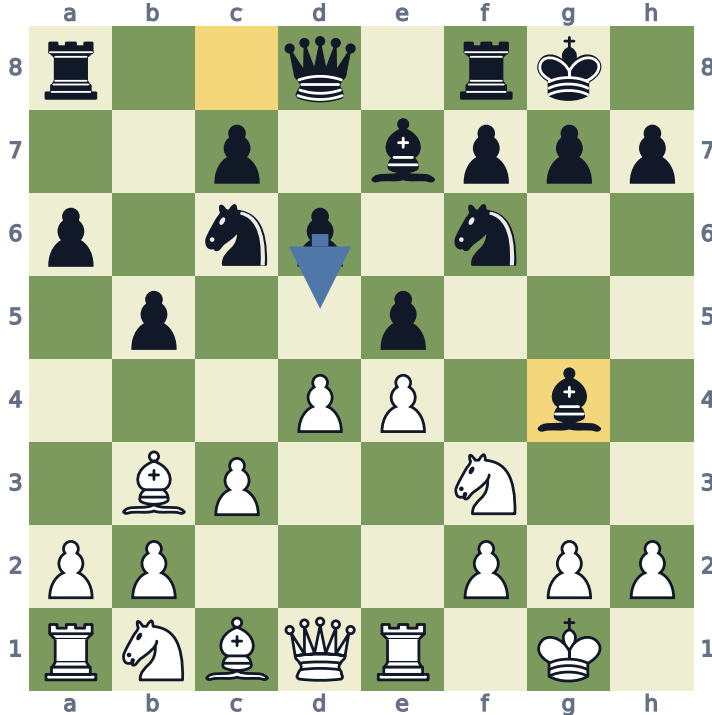
WHITE'S RESOURCES

White combines Bxc6, dxe5, and tactical pressure on pinned pieces to win central time.

MEMORY RULE | In Spanish tactics, ask whether the c6 knight is a defender in fact or only on paper.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Pressure on e5 often depends on whether the c6 knight is pinned and whether Black has a tactical reply against e4.

BLACK'S PLAN

Unpin when necessary, defend e5 with active pieces, and use counter-pressure instead of piling up passive defenders.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S PLAN

White combines Bxc6, dxe5, and tactical pressure on pinned pieces to win central time.

FAILURE MODE

Using simple attacker-defender counting while a pin changes which piece can legally recapture.

DECISION TEST

Ask: If the c6 knight moves or disappears, what becomes loose on e5, d4, or b5? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

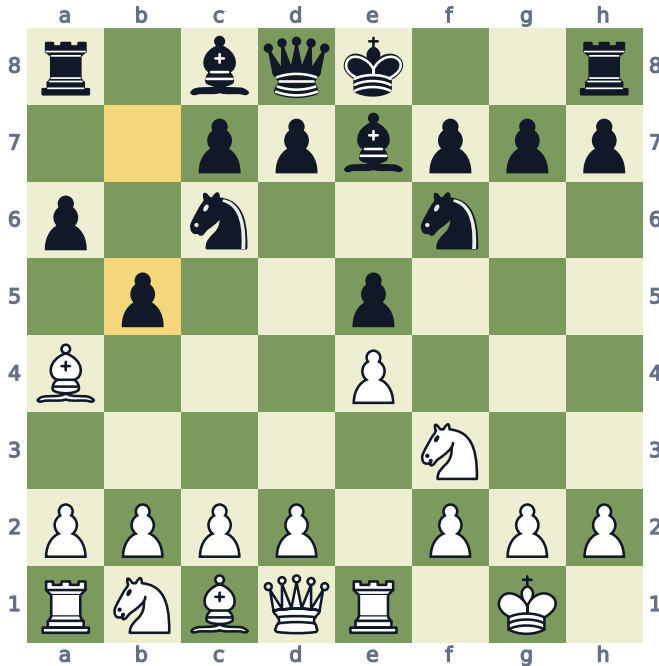
RULE | In Spanish tactics, ask whether the c6 knight is a defender in fact or only on paper.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 O-O 9. d4 Bg4



- Ba4: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight to f6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- Be7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Re1: White places a rook behind a file or pawn break expected to become important.
- b5: Black gains bishop tempo and queenside space while creating a possible pawn target.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Pressure on e5 often depends on whether the c6 knight is pinned and whether Black has a tactical reply against e4.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

If the c6 knight moves or disappears, what becomes loose on e5, d4, or b5? White's resource is: White combines Bxc6, dxe5, and tactical pressure on pinned pieces to win central time. The line fails as a template when: Using simple attacker-defender counting while a pin changes which piece can legally recapture.

STORE THIS | In Spanish tactics, ask whether the c6 knight is a defender in fact or only on paper.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

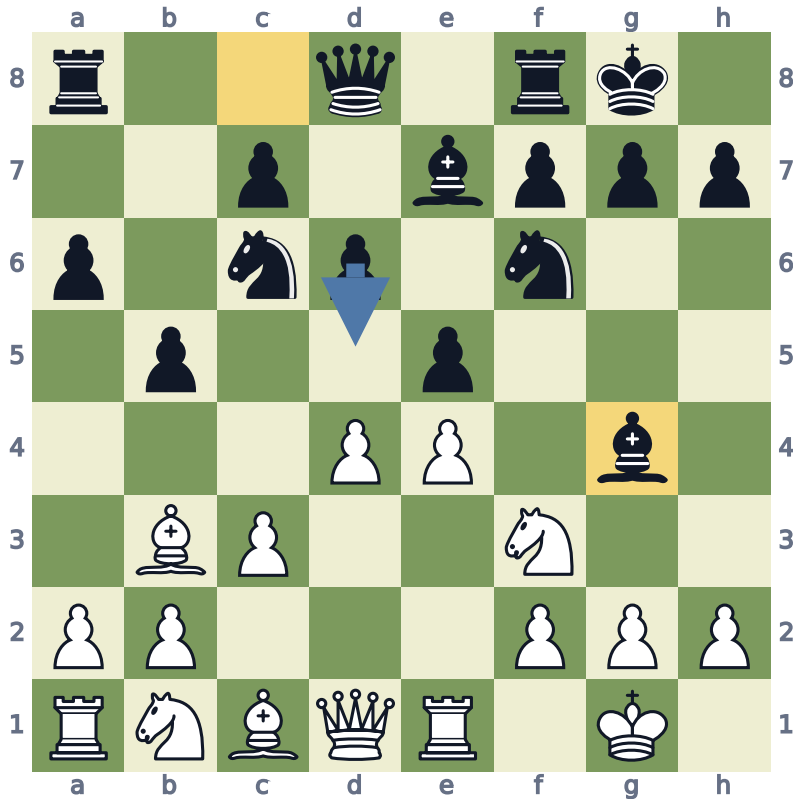
1. Pressure on e5 often depends on whether the c6 knight is pinned and whether Black has a tactical reply against e4. 2. Unpin when necessary, defend e5 with active pieces, and use counter-pressure instead of piling up passive defenders. 3. White combines Bxc6, dxe5, and tactical pressure on pinned pieces to win central time. 4. If the c6 knight moves or disappears, what becomes loose on e5, d4, or b5? 5. Using simple attacker-defender counting while a pin changes which piece can legally recapture.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The e5 pawn and the c6 pin



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Pressure on e5 often depends on whether the c6 knight is pinned and whether Black has a tactical reply against e4.

DECISION RULE

If the c6 knight moves or disappears, what becomes loose on e5, d4, or b5?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

Unpin when necessary, defend e5 with active pieces, and use counter-pressure instead of piling up passive defenders.

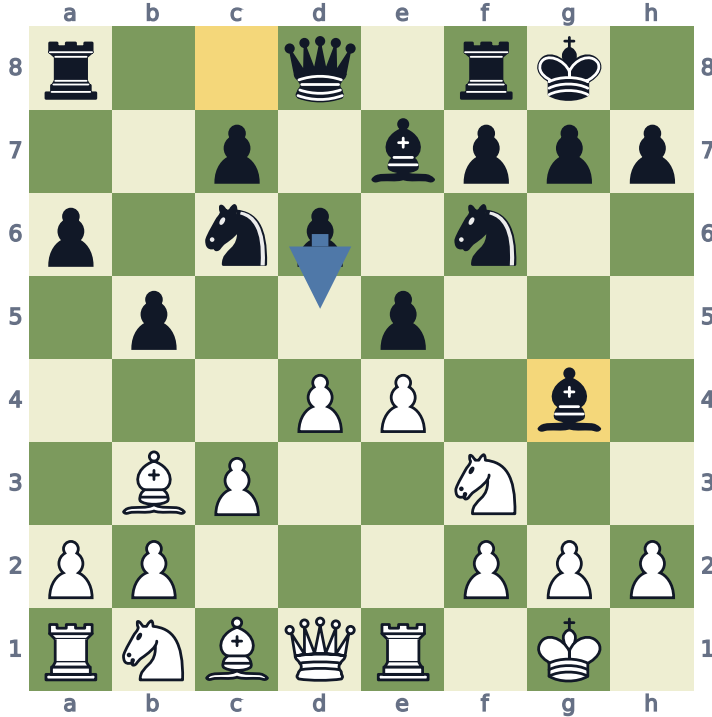
WHITE'S RESOURCES

White combines Bxc6, dxe5, and tactical pressure on pinned pieces to win central time.

MEMORY RULE | In Spanish tactics, ask whether the c6 knight is a defender in fact or only on paper.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Pressure on e5 often depends on whether the c6 knight is pinned and whether Black has a tactical reply against e4.

BLACK'S PLAN

Unpin when necessary, defend e5 with active pieces, and use counter-pressure instead of piling up passive defenders.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S PLAN

White combines Bxc6, dxe5, and tactical pressure on pinned pieces to win central time.

FAILURE MODE

Using simple attacker-defender counting while a pin changes which piece can legally recapture.

DECISION TEST

Ask: If the c6 knight moves or disappears, what becomes loose on e5, d4, or b5? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

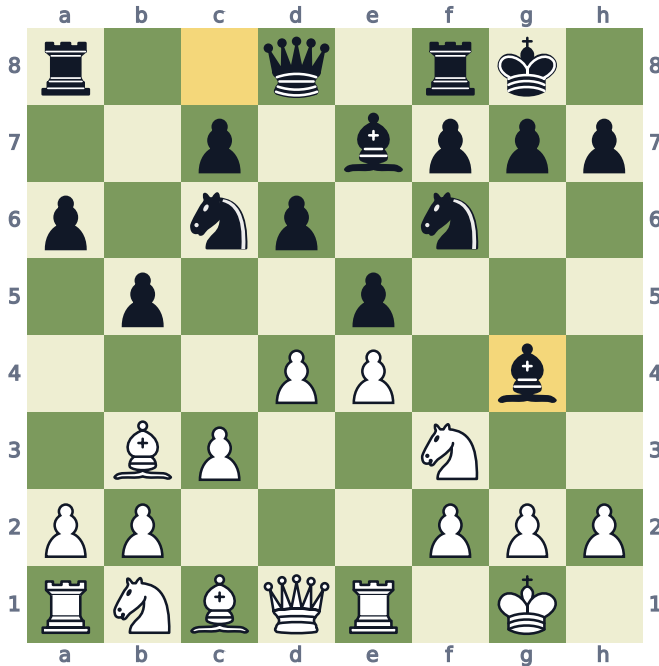
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 O-O 9. d4 Bg4



- Bb3: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- d6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- c3: White supports d4 and reserves c2 as a retreat square for the Spanish bishop.
- O-O: Black secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- d4: White challenges e5 and opens lines after the preparatory pieces are ready.
- Bg4: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Pressure on e5 often depends on whether the c6 knight is pinned and whether Black has a tactical reply against e4.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

If the c6 knight moves or disappears, what becomes loose on e5, d4, or b5? White's resource is: White combines Bxc6, dxe5, and tactical pressure on pinned pieces to win central time. The line fails as a template when: Using simple attacker-defender counting while a pin changes which piece can legally recapture.

STORE THIS | In Spanish tactics, ask whether the c6 knight is a defender in fact or only on paper.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

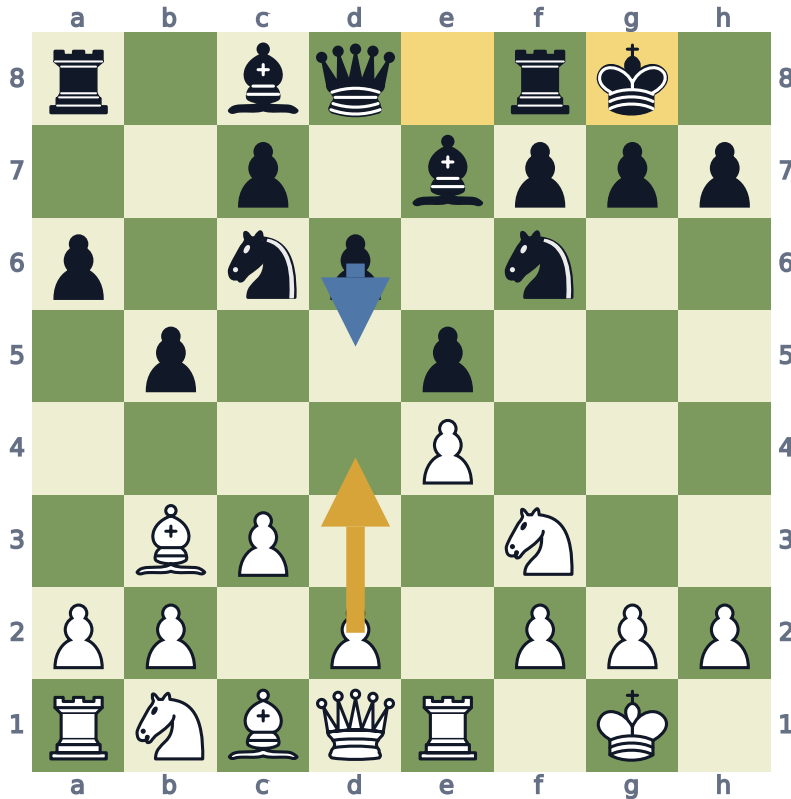
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 18 plies from memory, then replay: 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 O-O 9. d4 Bg4

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The bishop sacrifice on f7 or h7

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

The c2 bishop can become a tactical weapon on h7 once d4 or e5 clears the diagonal and the queen joins the attack.

DECISION RULE

After Bxh7+, where can the king go and what material or attack follows?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

Monitor the b1-h7 diagonal, create luft or defenders, and challenge the center before White aligns every attacker.

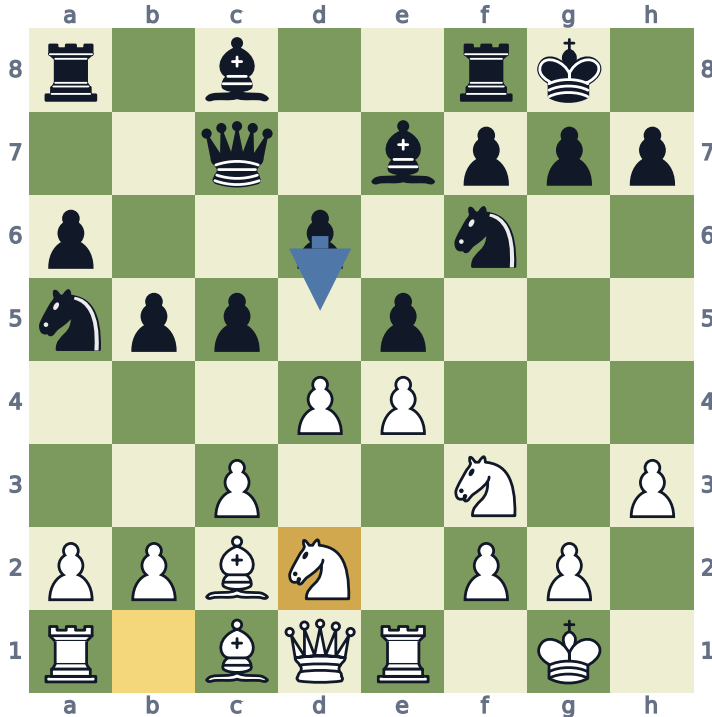
WHITE'S RESOURCES

White opens the diagonal with tempo and calculates Bxh7+ motifs based on king squares and knight support.

MEMORY RULE | A Greek-gift pattern needs access, support, and a trapped king.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The c2 bishop can become a tactical weapon on h7 once d4 or e5 clears the diagonal and the queen joins the attack.

BLACK'S PLAN

Monitor the b1-h7 diagonal, create luft or defenders, and challenge the center before White aligns every attacker.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S PLAN

White opens the diagonal with tempo and calculates Bxh7+ motifs based on king squares and knight support.

FAILURE MODE

Sacrificing because the bishop points at h7 without a queen route or knight follow-up.

DECISION TEST

Ask: After Bxh7+, where can the king go and what material or attack follows? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

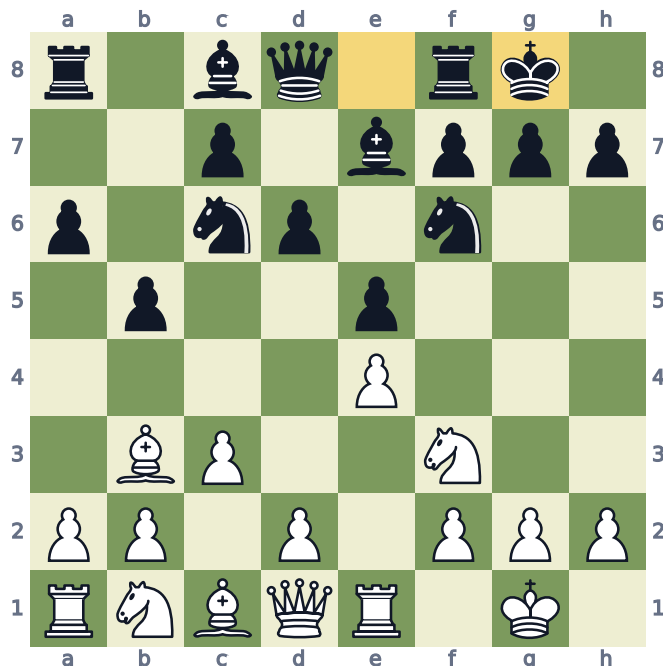
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 O-O 9. h3 Na5 10. Bc2 c5 11. d4 Qc7 12. Nbd2



- Re1: White places a rook behind a file or pawn break expected to become important.
- b5: Black gains bishop tempo and queenside space while creating a possible pawn target.
- Bb3: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- d6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- c3: White supports d4 and reserves c2 as a retreat square for the Spanish bishop.
- O-O: Black secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The c2 bishop can become a tactical weapon on h7 once d4 or e5 clears the diagonal and the queen joins the attack.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

After Bxh7+, where can the king go and what material or attack follows? White's resource is: White opens the diagonal with tempo and calculates Bxh7+ motifs based on king squares and knight support. The line fails as a template when: Sacrificing because the bishop points at h7 without a queen route or knight follow-up.

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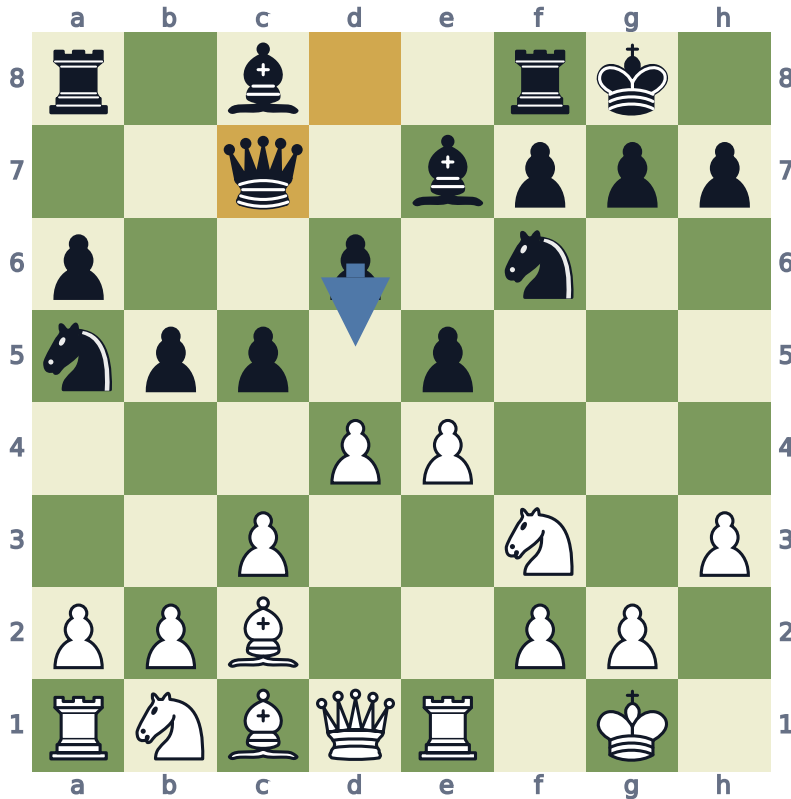
1. The c2 bishop can become a tactical weapon on h7 once d4 or e5 clears the diagonal and the queen joins the attack. 2. Monitor the b1-h7 diagonal, create luft or defenders, and challenge the center before White aligns every attacker. 3. White opens the diagonal with tempo and calculates Bxh7+ motifs based on king squares and knight support. 4. After Bxh7+, where can the king go and what material or attack follows? 5. Sacrificing because the bishop points at h7 without a queen route or knight follow-up.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 16 plies from memory, then replay: 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 O-O

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The bishop sacrifice on f7 or h7



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

The c2 bishop can become a tactical weapon on h7 once d4 or e5 clears the diagonal and the queen joins the attack.

DECISION RULE

After Bxh7+, where can the king go and what material or attack follows?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

Monitor the b1-h7 diagonal, create luft or defenders, and challenge the center before White aligns every attacker.

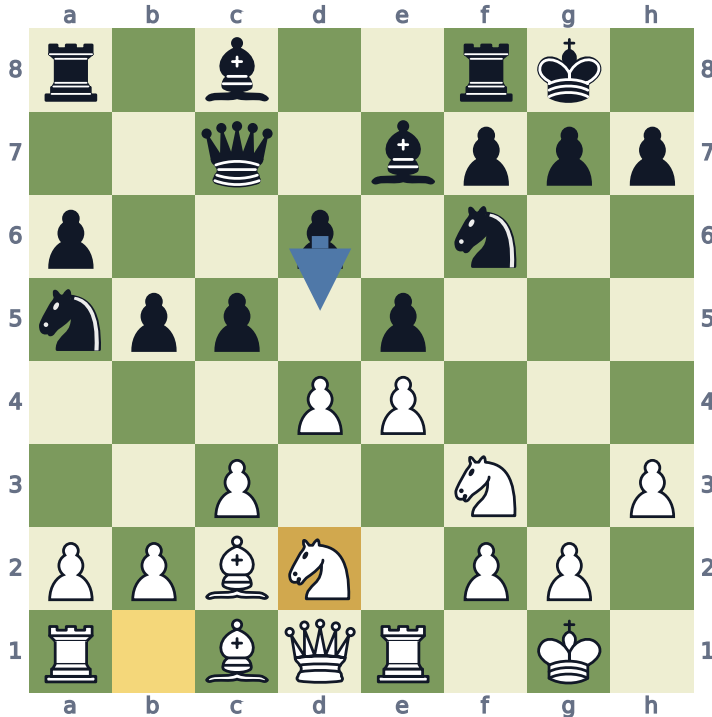
WHITE'S RESOURCES

White opens the diagonal with tempo and calculates Bxh7+ motifs based on king squares and knight support.

MEMORY RULE | A Greek-gift pattern needs access, support, and a trapped king.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The c2 bishop can become a tactical weapon on h7 once d4 or e5 clears the diagonal and the queen joins the attack.

BLACK'S PLAN

Monitor the b1-h7 diagonal, create luft or defenders, and challenge the center before White aligns every attacker.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S PLAN

White opens the diagonal with tempo and calculates Bxh7+ motifs based on king squares and knight support.

FAILURE MODE

Sacrificing because the bishop points at h7 without a queen route or knight follow-up.

DECISION TEST

Ask: After Bxh7+, where can the king go and what material or attack follows? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

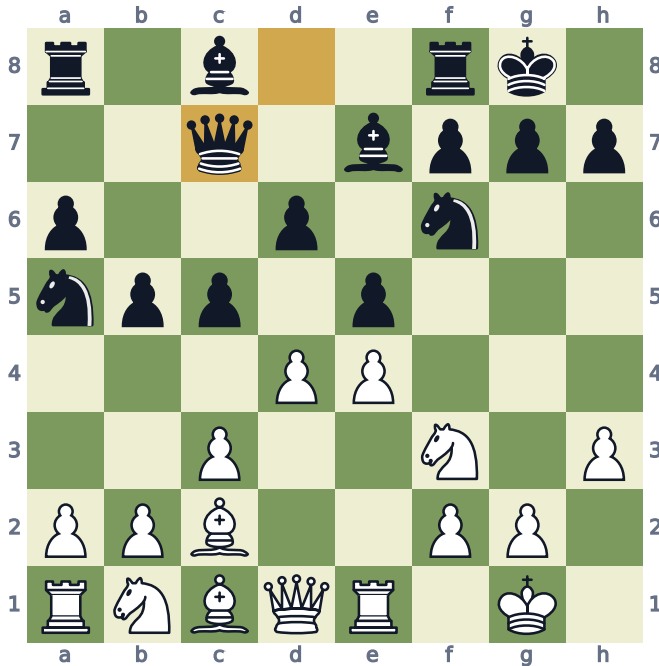
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

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- h3: White prevents a pin and supports the coming central plan at the cost of one tempo.
- Na5: Black reroutes a knight to a5; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Bc2: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- c5: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- d4: White challenges e5 and opens lines after the preparatory pieces are ready.
- Qc7: Black coordinates several plans, but the queen's safety and the opponent's forcing reply must be checked.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The c2 bishop can become a tactical weapon on h7 once d4 or e5 clears the diagonal and the queen joins the attack.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

After Bxh7+, where can the king go and what material or attack follows? White's resource is: White opens the diagonal with tempo and calculates Bxh7+ motifs based on king squares and knight support. The line fails as a template when: Sacrificing because the bishop points at h7 without a queen route or knight follow-up.

STORE THIS | A Greek-gift pattern needs access, support, and a trapped king.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

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ANSWER KEY

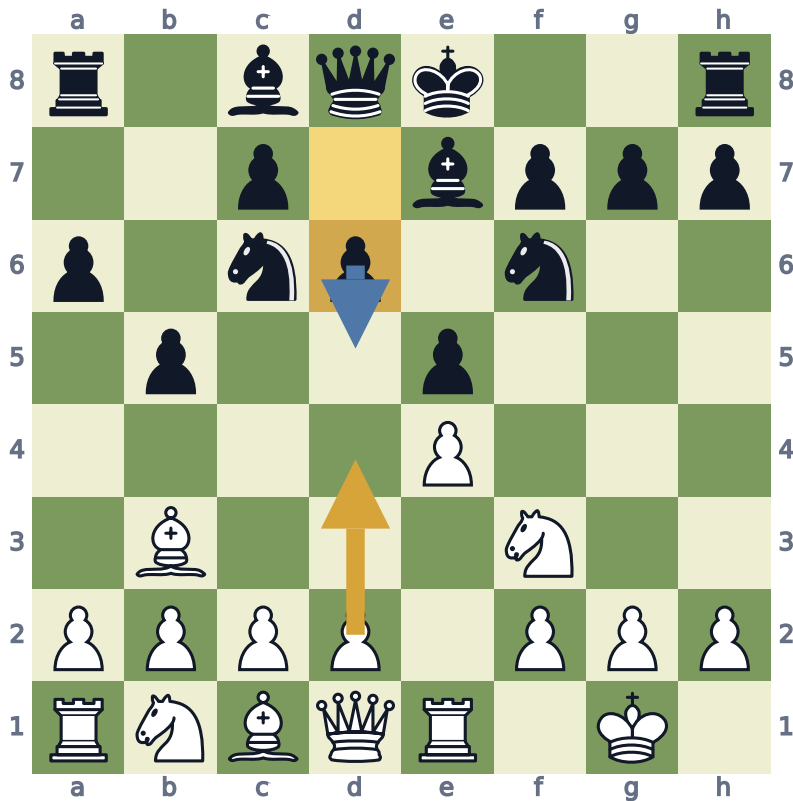
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 22 plies from memory, then replay: 9. h3 Na5 10. Bc2 c5 11. d4 Qc7

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Noah's Ark queenside trap



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...a6, ...b5, ...Na5, and ...c5 can gain bishop tempi, but the famous trap pattern works only if the bishop truly lacks a safe square.

DECISION RULE

If the queenside pawns advance one more time, where exactly can the bishop retreat?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

Gain space while tracking the bishop's retreat route and the central cost of each pawn move.

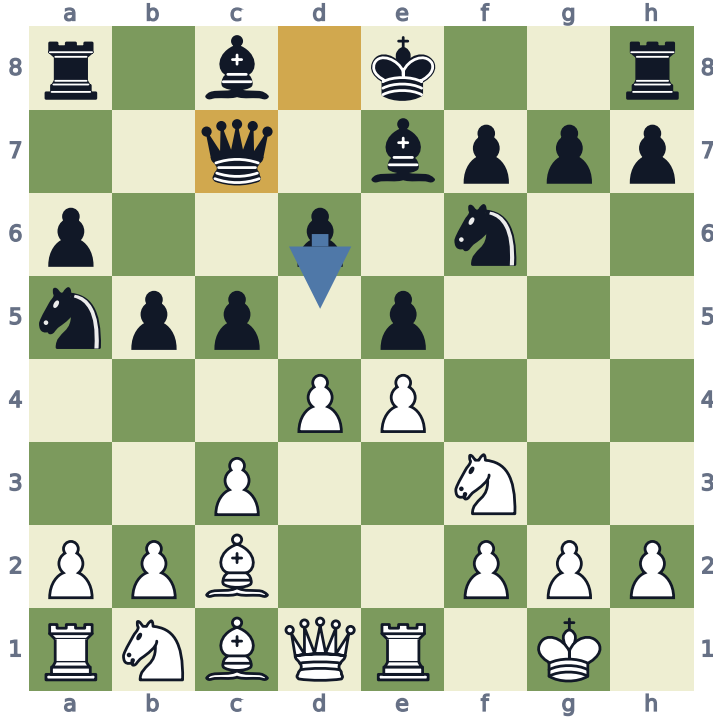
WHITE'S RESOURCES

White preserves the bishop via c2 and uses d4 to attack the pawn chain before it advances again.

MEMORY RULE | A trapping net is real only when every flight square is controlled.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

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BLACK'S PLAN

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FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S PLAN

White preserves the bishop via c2 and uses d4 to attack the pawn chain before it advances again.

FAILURE MODE

Playing the trap pattern by rote while White opens the center and escapes with tempo.

DECISION TEST

Ask: If the queenside pawns advance one more time, where exactly can the bishop retreat? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

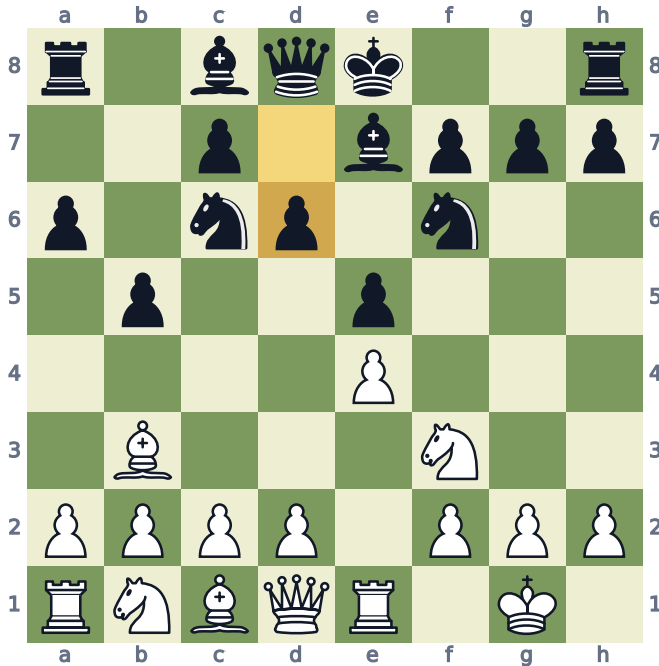
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

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- O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- Be7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
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WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

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WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

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ANSWER KEY

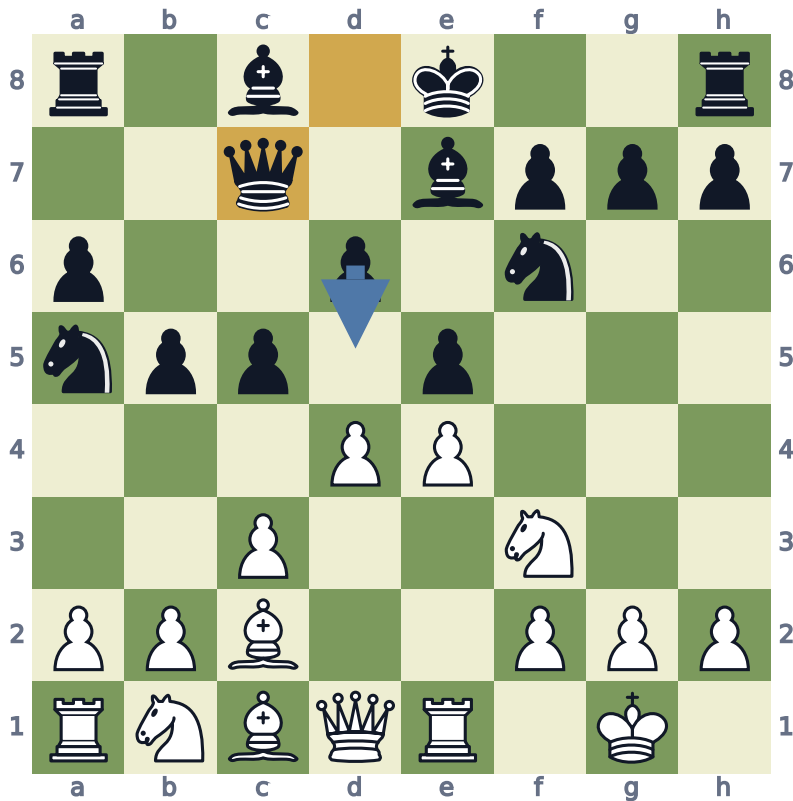
1. ...a6, ...b5, ...Na5, and ...c5 can gain bishop tempi, but the famous trap pattern works only if the bishop truly lacks a safe square. 2. Gain space while tracking the bishop's retreat route and the central cost of each pawn move. 3. White preserves the bishop via c2 and uses d4 to attack the pawn chain before it advances again. 4. If the queenside pawns advance one more time, where exactly can the bishop retreat? 5. Playing the trap pattern by rote while White opens the center and escapes with tempo.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 14 plies from memory, then replay: 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Noah's Ark queenside trap



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

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DECISION RULE

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SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

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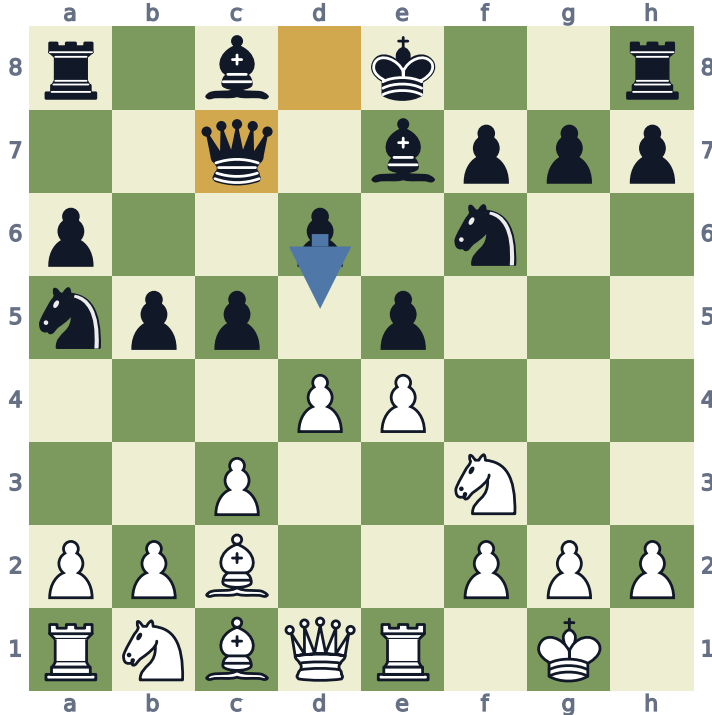
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CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



WHITE'S PLAN

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CUE

...a6, ...b5, ...Na5, and ...c5 can gain bishop tempi, but the famous trap pattern works only if the bishop truly lacks a safe square.

BLACK'S PLAN

Gain space while tracking the bishop's retreat route and the central cost of each pawn move.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

FAILURE MODE

Playing the trap pattern by rote while White opens the center and escapes with tempo.

DECISION TEST

Ask: If the queenside pawns advance one more time, where exactly can the bishop retreat? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

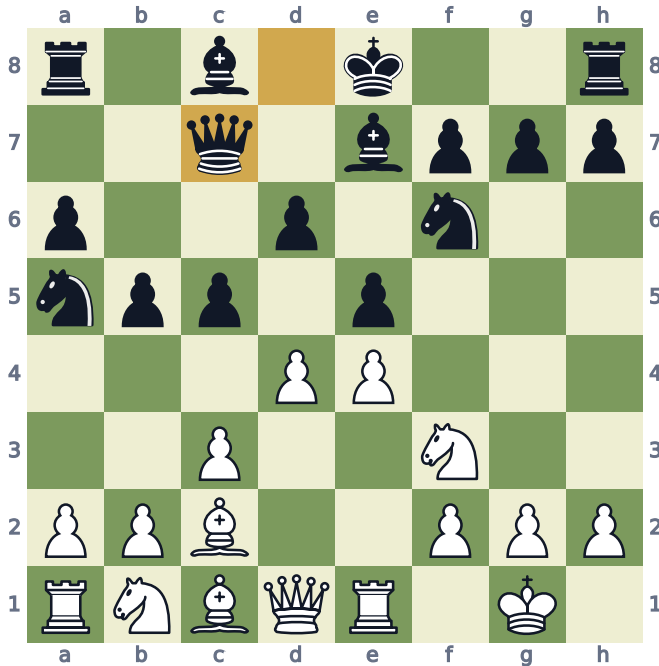
RULE | A trapping net is real only when every flight square is controlled.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 Na5 9. Bc2 c5 10. d4 Qc7



- c3: White supports d4 and reserves c2 as a retreat square for the Spanish bishop.
- Na5: Black reroutes a knight to a5; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Bc2: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- c5: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- d4: White challenges e5 and opens lines after the preparatory pieces are ready.
- Qc7: Black coordinates several plans, but the queen's safety and the opponent's forcing reply must be checked.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...a6, ...b5, ...Na5, and ...c5 can gain bishop tempi, but the famous trap pattern works only if the bishop truly lacks a safe square.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

If the queenside pawns advance one more time, where exactly can the bishop retreat? White's resource is: White preserves the bishop via c2 and uses d4 to attack the pawn chain before it advances again. The line fails as a template when: Playing the trap pattern by rote while White opens the center and escapes with tempo.

STORE THIS | A trapping net is real only when every flight square is controlled.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. ...a6, ...b5, ...Na5, and ...c5 can gain bishop tempi, but the famous trap pattern works only if the bishop truly lacks a safe square. 2. Gain space while tracking the bishop's retreat route and the central cost of each pawn move. 3. White preserves the bishop via c2 and uses d4 to attack the pawn chain before it advances again. 4. If the queenside pawns advance one more time, where exactly can the bishop retreat? 5. Playing the trap pattern by rote while White opens the center and escapes with tempo.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 20 plies from memory, then replay: 8. c3 Na5 9. Bc2 c5 10. d4 Qc7

SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 091 Decode: The e5 pawn and the c6 pin

Prompt: If the c6 knight moves or disappears, what becomes loose on e5, d4, or b5?

Recall: In Spanish tactics, ask whether the c6 knight is a defender in fact or only on paper.

LESSON 092 Play: The e5 pawn and the c6 pin

Prompt: If the c6 knight moves or disappears, what becomes loose on e5, d4, or b5?

Recall: In Spanish tactics, ask whether the c6 knight is a defender in fact or only on paper.

LESSON 093 Decode: The bishop sacrifice on f7 or h7

Prompt: After Bxh7+, where can the king go and what material or attack follows?

Recall: A Greek-gift pattern needs access, support, and a trapped king.

LESSON 094 Play: The bishop sacrifice on f7 or h7

Prompt: After Bxh7+, where can the king go and what material or attack follows?

Recall: A Greek-gift pattern needs access, support, and a trapped king.

LESSON 095 Decode: Noah's Ark queenside trap

Prompt: If the queenside pawns advance one more time, where exactly can the bishop retreat?

Recall: A trapping net is real only when every flight square is controlled.

LESSON 096 Play: Noah's Ark queenside trap

Prompt: If the queenside pawns advance one more time, where exactly can the bishop retreat?

Recall: A trapping net is real only when every flight square is controlled.

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's plan, White's plan, one candidate for the side to move, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

The e5 pawn and the c6 pin

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 O-O 9. d4 Bg4

Decision: If the c6 knight moves or disappears, what becomes loose on e5, d4, or b5?

Memory: In Spanish tactics, ask whether the c6 knight is a defender in fact or only on paper.

CARD 2

The bishop sacrifice on f7 or h7

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 O-O 9. h3 Na5 10. Bc2 c5 11. d4 Qc7 12. Nbd2

Decision: After Bxh7+, where can the king go and what material or attack follows?

Memory: A Greek-gift pattern needs access, support, and a trapped king.

CARD 3

Noah's Ark queenside trap

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7 6. Re1 b5 7. Bb3 d6 8. c3 Na5 9. Bc2 c5 10. d4 Qc7

Decision: If the queenside pawns advance one more time, where exactly can the bishop retreat?

Memory: A trapping net is real only when every flight square is controlled.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
091 Decode: The e5 pawn and the c6 pin	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
092 Play: The e5 pawn and the c6 pin	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
093 Decode: The bishop sacrifice on f7 or h7	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
094 Play: The bishop sacrifice on f7 or h7	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
095 Decode: Noah's Ark queenside trap	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
096 Play: Noah's Ark queenside trap	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name both sides' strongest plans, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.